

Common Linux Networking Tools

ifconfig

Shows or configures network interfaces (older tool; use 'ip' instead).

ip

Modern replacement for ifconfig. Used to show/manipulate IP addresses, routing, interfaces, etc.

route

Displays or modifies the IP routing table. (Deprecated, 'ip route' is preferred now).

arp

Shows and manages the ARP table (maps IP to MAC addresses).

hostname

Shows or sets the system's hostname.

ping

Tests reachability of a host by sending ICMP echo requests.

traceroute

Tracks the route packets take to reach a host.

tracepath

Similar to traceroute but doesn't require root.

mtr

Combines ping and traceroute for real-time route diagnostics.

dig

Queries DNS name servers for information (very detailed).

nslookup

Also queries DNS but older than dig.

host

Simple DNS lookup utility.

netstat

Shows network connections, routing tables, interface stats (older; 'ss' preferred now).

ss

Faster and more modern replacement for netstat.

tcpdump

Captures network packets in real-time (powerful packet analyzer).

curl

Transfers data from or to a server using various protocols (HTTP, FTP, etc.).

wget

Retrieves content from web servers (good for downloading files).

whois

Queries domain registration and ownership info.